answer to the issue of sustainable income generation by the villagers of Arunachal Pradesh.

All that was required was to add value to the raw bamboo and cane that is found in abundance in Arunachal. A pilot project was conceptualized by me in Poma village, where we created a workshop and put in a few low-technology machines that would enable the youth and women to process the bamboo and make simple products. This project was facilitated by the departments of planning and environment and forests, and implemented by the Forest Corporation Limited of Arunachal Pradesh. A few young men and women were sent to Guwahati to undergo a short training capsule, and the Poma project was off to a start. It has been handed over to the village development society management. Today, it is a source of great joy and satisfaction to see the village humming with activity with about forty families actively involved in producing thin bamboo sticks for the incense sticks and other handicrafts to meet the unending orders. More importantly, entrepreneurial instincts and skills have been generated in the people of this once sleepy village. Poma is now being turned into a model village. The road has been black-topped under the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sarak Yojana (PMGSY) and the special plan assistance programme, the school has been upgraded and the primary health centre has also been renovated. Now we are witnessing a growing demand from other rural areas of Arunachal Pradesh for starting similar projects. Taking a step further towards facilitating the expansion of this concept as demanded by the people, a training programme for a fortnight was conducted at Poma, and was attended by villagers and small entrepreneurs from other districts.